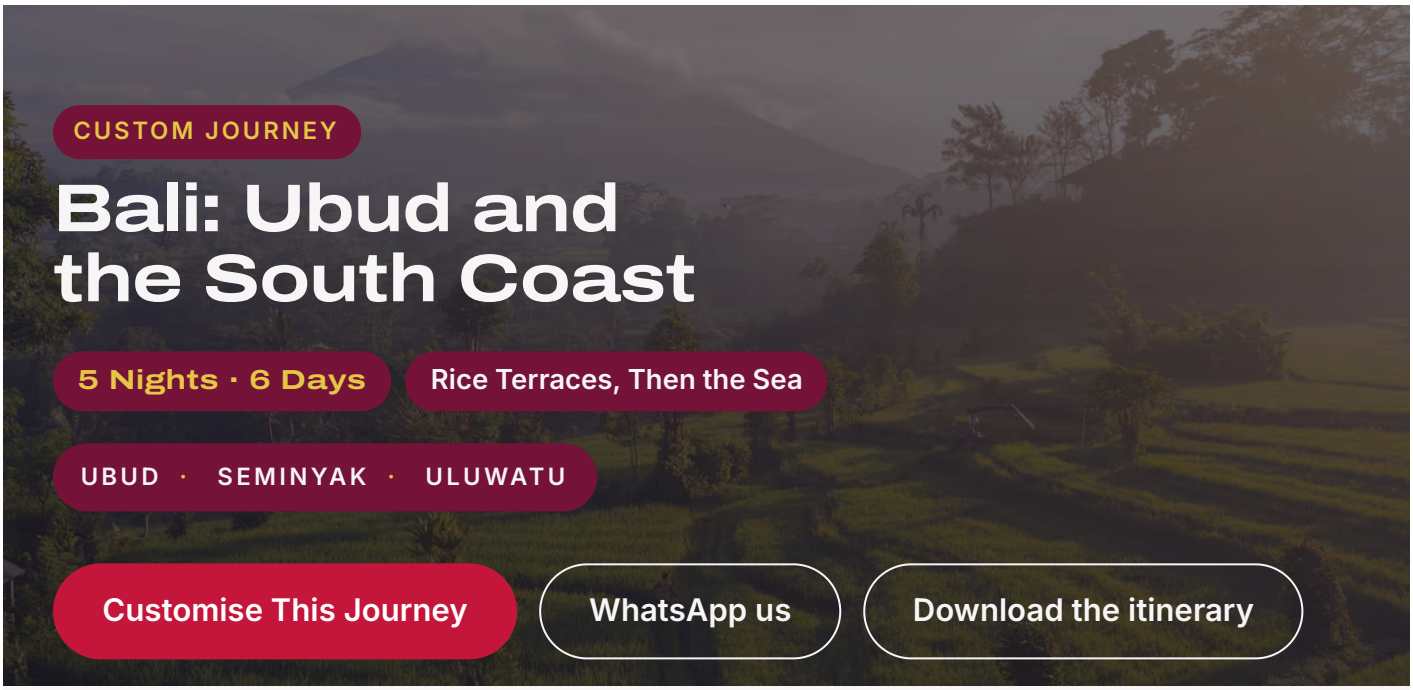
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CUSTOM JOURNEY

Bali: Ubud and the South Coast

5 Nights · 6 Days | Rice Terraces, Then the Sea

UBUD · SEMINYAK · ULUWATU

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DURATION
5 Nights · 6 Days

ROUTE
Denpasar return

PACE
Relaxed

BEST SEASON
April to October

IDEAL FOR
Couples, Solo, First-Timers

Bali is two islands pretending to be one. Inland there is Ubud: rice terraces cut into the hillsides, irrigation shared between villages by temple committee rather than by government, art studios down every back lane, and a quiet that takes about a day to adjust to. On the south coast there is the other Bali: surf, long west-facing beaches, and a clifftop temple that has been watching the Indian Ocean since the eleventh century.

This itinerary gives you three nights of the first and two of the second, in that order, because the pace only works one way round. It also leaves one full day with nothing in it at all. That is not an oversight. It is the most useful day of the six, and the one people tell us about afterwards.

Journey Highlights

- **Settle** into Ubud, Bali's green and cultural heart, where terraced fields, art studios and small temples set an unhurried tone.
- **Walk** the Tegallalang rice terraces in early morning light, before the coaches arrive and while the mist is still in the valley.
- **Browse** Ubud's art market and the studios around it, then eat a proper Balinese dinner rather than a resort approximation.
- **Cross** the island south in under two hours, trading jungle green for ocean blue and a beach-side base.
- **Watch** sunset at Uluwatu Temple, set on a cliff two hundred feet above the surf on the island's south-western tip.
- **Keep** one day entirely unplanned. The south coast is best understood by not scheduling it.

Itinerary at a Glance

DAY	DESTINATION	SIGNATURE EXPERIENCE
Day 01	**Ubud**	Fly into Denpasar and head inland to the rice-field country
Day 02	**Ubud**	Tegallalang terraces at first light, then the art market
Day 03	**Seminyak / Uluwatu**	South to the coast; an evening watching the sun go down
Day 04	**Uluwatu**	A clifftop temple at sunset, and a slow beach day either side
Day 05	**South coast**	A day deliberately left open

DAY	DESTINATION	SIGNATURE EXPERIENCE
Day 06	**Departure**	A free morning before the flight out of Denpasar

Day by Day

Expand all

Day 01 Ubud: Inland to the Green Heart

Fly · into Denpasar

Fly into Denpasar and head inland, away from the coast, to Ubud. This is Bali's cultural centre and its greenest quarter: terraced rice fields stepping down the valleys, art studios on the back lanes, and small family temples on almost every corner. Check in (a rice-field or jungle-view room is worth asking for) and do nothing much. The point of starting here rather than at the beach is that Ubud sets the pace for the rest of it.

Overnight in Ubud

Day 02 Ubud: Terraces and the Art Market

Out early to Tegallalang, where the rice terraces are cut into the hillside in the subak system the island has used since the ninth century, a network of irrigation shared between villages and managed by temple committees rather than by anyone official. Morning light and an early start are what separate this from the photograph everyone has seen. Later, Ubud town: the art market, the studios around it, and a Balinese dinner that involves more than one dish and takes a while.

Overnight in Ubud

Day 03 To the Coast: Ubud to Seminyak

Drive · 1.5 to 2 hours

A short transfer south, an hour and a half or so depending on traffic through Denpasar, and the landscape changes completely: jungle green gives way to ocean blue, and the pace shifts from contemplative to coastal. Check in to a beach-side stay, and keep the evening free. The west-facing beaches here do the best sunsets on the island, and you will want to be sitting down for it rather than travelling.

Overnight in Seminyak

Day 04 Uluwatu: A Temple on the Cliff

A slow beach day built around one unmissable thing. Pura Luhur Uluwatu stands on a limestone cliff some seventy metres above the Indian Ocean at the island's south-western tip, and has done since the eleventh century. Go for sunset, when the temple is a silhouette and the surf is a long way below. The resident macaques are practised thieves: sunglasses off, pockets closed. Either side of it, the beach clubs or a quiet stretch of sand, as you prefer.

Overnight in Seminyak

Day 05 South Coast: A Day Left Open

Nothing is scheduled today, and that is deliberate. The south coast rewards people who know when to stop planning. If you would rather fill it, the obvious candidates are a traditional Balinese massage (an hour, and genuinely not a spa-menu imitation) or a first surf lesson on the gentler beach breaks at Kuta or Canggu. Both can be arranged the evening before.

Overnight in Seminyak

Day 06 Denpasar: Departure

A free morning to take the last of the island calm, then the transfer to Denpasar for your flight. Most connections back to India route through Singapore or Kuala Lumpur, so allow a little more airport time than a direct service would need.

Departure

Practical notes

Visa

Indonesia offers visa-on-arrival to Indian passport holders, valid for 30 days. Carry a passport with at least six months' validity and a confirmed onward ticket.

Getting there

There are no direct flights from most Indian cities. Typical connections run via Singapore, Kuala Lumpur or Jakarta into Denpasar (DPS).

Best time to visit

April to October is the dry season and the reliable window. December to February is the heart of the monsoon and best avoided if your dates are flexible.

Currency

Indonesian Rupiah. Cards are widely accepted in Ubud and Seminyak; carry cash for smaller towns, warungs and temple donations.

Getting around

A private car with a driver is by far the easiest way to move between Ubud and the coast, and costs less than you would expect.